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Introduction to Business Frameworks
Session - 5

26th September, 2026

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Agenda

1 Level AI - Customer Strategy for $10Mn ARR

2 Cheerio AI - Customer strategy for $10Mn ARR



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Crux of the case

Which segment, use case and GTM motion gets us to $10M ARR in India?

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Where do we play?

Score industries on volume, ROI clarity, and fit with our English-first, integration-heavy product

Dimension	What to test	Why it matters
Call volume	Calls/minutes per customer	Determines revenue pool
Pain intensity	Cost, SLA, manpower, missed calls	Determines willingness to pay & automate
Automation feasibility	% of calls AI can handle	Determines achievable ROI
Measurability	Clear baseline + outcome metric	Makes ROI provable
Integration complexity	Can we handle	Aligns with our edge being enterprise auth & systems integration, not no-code
Competitive intensity	Local alternatives / incumbents	Determines differentiation required
Replicability	Can the same playbook work across customers?	Determines path to $10M

Prioritise high-volume, repetitive workflows where ROI can be measured directly.

E.g., NBFCs & insurers (collections reminders, claims/KYC status, policy renewal) and hospital/diagnostic chains (appointment booking, authentication, follow-ups)

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Size of opportunity via bottom-up sizing

Target cos × relevant calls/company/month × mins/call × ₹/min × 12

Industry	Use case	Target cos	Calls/co/ month	Min/call	Annual mins	₹/min	Revenue pool
I1	I1 x UC 1	X	X	X	X	X	₹X Cr
I1	I1 x UC 2	X	X	X	X	X	₹X Cr
I1	I1 x UC 3	X	X	X	X	X	₹X Cr
I2	I2 x UC 1	X	X	X	X	X	₹X Cr
I2	I2 x UC 1	X	X	X	X	X	₹X Cr

Objective: Select the 1–2 segments with enough volume + pain + willingness to pay to support a $10M ARR ambition, and what market share would we need

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Pricing I Multiple options available; objective not to be cheapest but to sell value prop

- **Options:**
  - **Sell a hybrid contract:**
    - Platform fee (integration, auth, uptime SLA)
    - Capped usage, quoted in ₹, not pure per-minute
    - Usage bands in ₹/min above a committed volume
  - **In-line with Indian market**:
    - Primarily ₹/minute, with some outcome-based pricing
- **Objective**: Mid-tier pricing - selling integration depth & compliance readiness (DPDP, data-residency, etc. vs no-code tools), not being cheapest

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GTM Motion I Enterprise sales viable at >$50k ACV + highly targeted outbound

- **Focus on enterprise sales**
  - $50K+ ACV with 8–12 week compliance-heavy deployments, Sales + Product + Tech motion needed to close & retain large accounts:
    - Named target accounts, with compelling use case
    - ROI-led pilots, before expanding across workflows
- Evaluate **specific partners** that already **own enterprise relationships + solve specific bottlenecks for us** (distribution, credibility, implementation or integration),
  - E.g., Telephony providers, CCaaS platforms, BPOs, Cloud marketplaces,
  - E.g., Exotel - data-residency, telephony licensing, & BFSI/healthcare relationships
  - Plug our voice agent on top vs rebuilding telephony/compliance from scratch
  - Differentiated AI layer to bundle for them; faster time-to-live and warm intros for us

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Can we actually get to $10M ARR?

- **Number of logos needed, basis ACV**
- **Beachhead**
  - 10 lighthouse customers → Prove ROI → Replicate within the same vertical →Expand use cases → Add adjacent verticals
- **Biggest risk**: our English-first, dollar-platform-priced product loses RFPs to local vernacular + cheaper vendors (Yellow.ai, Gnani, Skit.ai) — especially once BFSI/insurance procurement pushes call centers into Tier-2/3 cities where English-only isn't enough.
- **Mitigation**: stay in metro/digital-first accounts where English is acceptable for 1-2 yrs months; invest R&D (2-3 highest-ROI languages) for won accounts, not upfront

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The Decision: Where should Cheerio enter the US?

- **Objective:**
  - Win 10 paying US customers + $10K MRR within 6 months
- **Constraints**
  - $50K incremental launch budget
  - 2 India-based GTM employees
  - Up to 4 engineer-weeks of adaptation
  - No US office / full-time US hires
  - One customer segment
  - One lead workflow
  - One primary acquisition channel

Which specific US customer segment + workflow should Cheerio target first, and how can it win the first 10 customers?

Pick the Beachhead, Not the Market

Dimension	Question
Problem intensity	Is the workflow painful/urgent?
Buyer clarity	Can we identify one decision-maker?
Economic value	Is the ROI large enough to pay for?
Reachability	Can 2 GTM people actually find them?
Transferability	Does India's product experience transfer?

A startup entering a new market should narrow the problem before broadening the market.

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What Exactly Are We Selling? Wish to sell a specific workflow → specific customer outcome

- Pitch structure
  - Customer: [specific segment]
  - Workflow: [specific problem]
  - Current alternative: [Klaviyo / Intercom / Twilio / agency / internal process]
  - Cheerio intervention: [specific capability]
  - Outcome: [revenue / conversion / cost / response-time improvement]
  - Price: $X/month
- Critical strategic choice
  - Replace incumbent vs Work alongside incumbent
  - “Why would a customer change something that already works?”
  - Migration, retraining and perceived risk can outweigh a broader feature set or lower price.

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Rest of the case

- Getting to 10 paying customers
  - What channels to use?
  - How many meetings/pitches needed
- Launch budget & Customer Economics
- Experiment loop - validate problem, WTP and repeatability
  - Continue if evidence supports segment + workflow + channel


Q&A